LAF YOMI

Bekhorot 49 · November 06, 2026

ON TODAY'S DAF

Bekhorot 49 stays with פדיון הבן: the intermingled babies — the kohen, the power of attorney, and why a הרשאה can't be written on movables. Then the mishnah of a son who dies before, on, or after day thirty, the גזירה שוה of חודש חודש, and רבי עקיבא's ספק. A father who dies before redeeming his son, who comes first — self or son — Rav against שמואל on money paid early and spent, and the Tyrian maneh.

מאי שנא · THE KOHEN'S DIVIDE AND CONQUER



1. Two fathers paid five selaim each to one kohen; then one baby died within thirty days. Why can't the kohen deflect each father separately: your son was the live one?

“Tosafot: together, the fathers win — ממה נפשך, he holds an extra five selaim. Separately, divide and conquer: each one alone goes home empty-handed.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 49a · בבא בהרשאה — the kohen plays divide and conquer · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 4:46

הרשאה · THE POWER OF ATTORNEY THAT LOOKS LIKE A LIE



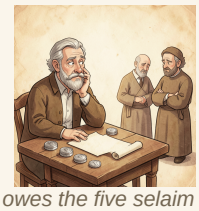
2. Shmuel saves the mishnah: the father comes with a הרשאה, a power of attorney from the other father, so the kohen can't dismiss him with 'you're not my litigant.' But Nehardea objects: we don't write a הרשאה for movables.

“Why not? Rashi: movables aren't sitting visibly before you — they move around, and maybe the man has none at all. The witnesses would look like they signed a lie.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 49a · לא כתבינן אדרכתא אמיטלטלי — a power of attorney that looks like a lie · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 7:30

מת הבן · SHEHECHEYANU FOR A PIDYON AFTER THE CHILD DIED



3. A son died after thirty days, so the father still owes the five selaim — for a child already gone. Tosafot: pidyon carries two brachot, the pidyon and a שהחיינו. But does a grieving father say שהחיינו?

“Tosafot leaves it a safek; the Rema rules no — ספק ברכות להקל. Why does pidyon get a שהחיינו when a bris doesn't? Because pidyon is rare. The Vilna Gaon disagreed — שהחיינו at every bris.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 49a · מת הבן בתוך שלושים — shehecheyanu for a dead child's pidyon · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 18:56

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הפודה את בנו · THE KIDDUSHIN OF HIS SISTER



4. A father pays within thirty days, for the pidyon to take effect after thirty — but the money is gone by then. Rashi: if he meant it 'from now,' it just remains a gift to the kohen. The acharonim ask: what did he mean to give?

“They test Rashi with a parallel: a man gives money to his sister as kiddushin — knowing it can't work. Gift, or deposit? Rashi says 'gift'; the acharonim wonder why not 'deposit.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 49a · הפודה את בנו בתוך שלושים — the kiddushin of his sister · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 37:35

נתעכלו המעות · THE KOHEN SPENT THE MONEY



5. Rav and Shmuel: a father pays within thirty days for the pidyon to take effect after thirty — but by day thirty-one the kohen has spent the money. Rav says the son is redeemed anyway, like kiddushin after thirty days even if the money was squandered.

“Rav: if the woman won't return the money, it's as if she received it on day thirty — so the kohen who won't refund the five selaim has, in effect, just been paid. Shmuel: by kiddushin he could have married her right now; by pidyon he couldn't redeem right now — so it was only a deposit, and a spent deposit redeems nothing.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 49a–b · נתעכלו המעות — the kohen spent the money · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 38:45

מלוה הכתובה בתורה · REPOSSESSING FIELDS FOR PIDYON, NOT FOR TEFILLIN



6. A man has only five selaim, and needs a pidyon for himself and for his son. Rabbi Yehudah says the son comes first — but Rabbi Yirmiyah re-reads him: the case is five liened selaim and five free ones, and a Torah loan counts as if written in a document, so the kohen can repossess the liened fields.

“The Mishnah Berurah: a mitzvah costs at most a fifth of your property — how can a man with only five selaim spend them all? The Chazon Ish: pidyon is a debt, not a mitzvah expense. A man with no tzitzit, no mezuzah, no tefillin can't repossess sold fields to buy tefillin — but the kohen can repossess them for pidyon haben.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 49b · מלוה הכתובה בתורה — repossessing fields for pidyon, not for tefillin · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 59:40